Paper III • Unit I • Topic 4 — Telangana Social Issues and Social Movements: Substantive Research Repair

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1. Reading the syllabus as an interconnected social history

The syllabus names Vetti, Jogini and Devadasi systems, the girl child, fluorosis, child labour, migrant labour, child marriage and social movements in Telangana. These are not eight disconnected facts. They ask how economic dependence, caste authority, gendered control, environmental exposure and unequal access to public institutions produce vulnerability; and how collective action alters the distribution of voice and resources. A high-scoring answer should identify the specific mechanism rather than use poverty as a universal explanation. Poverty may make a family susceptible to coercion, but an institution that permits caste-based forced service requires a theory of social power; excessive fluoride in groundwater requires hydrogeological investigation; a child marriage requires a gender and legal-capacity analysis.

A useful framework has five stages: historical institution → present-day mechanism → affected capabilities → applicable law and delivery institution → testable outcome. For example, Vetti historically meant coerced services to local powerholders; the present-day warning sign may be an advance-linked work obligation that a worker cannot freely exit; the lost capability is freedom of labour; Article 23 and labour protections supply legal routes; a valid outcome is independently verified release and sustained livelihood, not merely registration of a complaint. The same structure can be used to distinguish an effective social movement from a temporary protest: durable organisation must change incentives, institutions or the distribution of rights.

2. Vetti, agrarian hierarchy and the meaning of freedom of labour

2.1 How coercion was embedded in the village economy

Under parts of the Hyderabad State's agrarian system, local landholders and intermediary authorities could demand unpaid or underpaid labour, transport, domestic service and ceremonial work. The local vocabulary of Vetti is historically important because the obligation was not always framed as a market contract. A household might be compelled to perform work because of inherited service status, caste hierarchy, debt, dependence on a landlord for tenancy or fear of eviction. Such relationships blurred the distinction between economic dependence and overt compulsion. Not every unpaid family activity is Vetti, and historical obligations differed across villages; a serious answer avoids the claim that every landlord exercised identical powers.

The economic consequences were cumulative. Days spent on compulsory service reduced the time available to cultivate one's own plot, learn a skill or seek wages elsewhere. Coercion could therefore reproduce indebtedness: the worker lost earning capacity and then became more dependent on credit or grain advances. The political consequences were equally serious because a household unable to refuse service had little practical ability to complain about rent, land records or police abuse. The mechanism illustrates the difference between formal liberty (a law says labour is free) and substantive liberty (a worker can actually refuse without losing food, housing or safety).

2.2 Resistance and legal change are separate historical stages

Telangana's peasant mobilisation of 1946–51 opposed coercive labour, arbitrary levies, eviction and landlord domination. It is analytically wrong to treat the 1948 integration of Hyderabad, the agrarian struggle and the 1976 bonded-labour legislation as a single event. Political integration changed sovereignty; agrarian organisation challenged village power; later law established enforceable statutory rights. Their effects were related but neither immediate nor identical. The movement also combined different constituencies and strategies, so its achievements and violence require evidence-sensitive assessment rather than celebration by default.

Article 23 of the Constitution prohibits traffic in human beings, begar and other similar forms of forced labour. The Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976 addresses debt-linked and other bonded labour relations, including extinguishment of bonded debt and release from obligations. These legal categories overlap

historically with Vetti but should not be used as exact synonyms. A district officer must identify the actual restriction on movement, wage withholding, threats, advances, tenancy dependence and the worker's ability to leave. Release without rehabilitation, land access, wages and a safe complaint channel may leave the person vulnerable to the same employer or a different recruiter.

2.3 Administrative case: brick kiln workers

Suppose a family working at a kiln near Hyderabad received a cash advance from a recruiter and is told it cannot leave until an opaque account is settled. Children are helping to meet a family output target. A competent response separates urgent protection from later adjudication: confidentially interview adults and children away from the recruiter; record recruitment and wage evidence; assess bonded labour and child labour independently; coordinate labour, police, child protection and district administration; and arrange safe transport, identity documents, school re-entry and follow-up. The critical question is whether consent was meaningful when refusal meant debt threats or confinement. Counting rescue operations alone is not a measure of durable freedom.

3. Jogini and Devadasi: regional forms, caste-gender domination and law

3.1 Distinguish practices without erasing survivors

Jogini is a regional form of ritual dedication associated in some localities with caste and gender inequality. Devadasi is a broader historical term whose social meanings varied by period and place; not every historical performer or temple-linked artist had the same experience. A defensible textbook account therefore distinguishes a coercive dedication institution from the full diversity of South Indian performance history. The issue for contemporary public policy is not to stereotype a community or religion. It is whether girls and women are denied autonomy, schooling, safety, property and freedom to marry because an obligation is imposed in the name of custom.

Social mechanisms can include vows made during illness, local ritual authority, caste pressure, family insecurity and dependence on patrons. These mechanisms may reinforce each other without being present in every case. A girl cannot be treated as having freely chosen a life-defining status because an adult relative consented or a community approved. The gendered harm may persist after the public ceremony stops: social stigma, exclusion from marriage, poor access to healthcare and income insecurity can continue. An effective programme must therefore be survivor-centred, confidential and long-term, not a one-day rescue photograph.

3.2 Read the 1988 Act precisely

The original Andhra Pradesh Devadasis (Prohibition of Dedication) Act, 1988, adapted for Telangana in 2016, is Act No. 10 of 1988. Its definition expressly includes Jogini among local labels. Section 3 declares dedication unlawful and void regardless of whether the woman was said to consent; the legislation also protects marriage validity and children from stigma arising solely from the dedication. The Act places enforcement responsibilities on designated officers, including the Collector. A strong mains answer names the legislation and explains its logic: abolish the imposed status, do not punish the dedicated woman, and restore civil capacity and dignity. The statutory text is available through the official India Code PDF; the particular rules and enforcement data must be checked separately.

A prohibition-only strategy may fail if survivors lack land, income, counselling and safe housing. Community education is necessary, but it should not become public identification of survivors. Police action against organisers of dedication and welfare support for affected women serve different purposes and must be coordinated. One can measure effectiveness through school retention among at-risk girls, survivors' access to bank accounts and housing, confidential complaints resolved, and absence of re-dedication—not through a claim that a village is 'free of the practice' without a reliable method of verification.

3.3 Administrative case: threatened dedication

A teacher hears that a 14-year-old may be dedicated during a village festival. The appropriate response is to protect the child first: discreetly contact child-protection authorities, establish her immediate safety and schooling, document evidence without exposing her publicly, and coordinate with police and the revenue authorities empowered under the relevant statute. A health or counselling referral should not be conditional on testimony. The family may need livelihood assistance, but economic support is not a substitute for enforcement. The ethical test is whether the child gains sustained choice and safety, not whether an official ceremony was

prevented in front of cameras.

4. Girl child: discrimination across the life course

4.1 Why birth, schooling and work must be analysed together

Disadvantage to the girl child is not a single indicator. It can begin with prenatal sex preference, unequal nutrition and health spending, and continue through unpaid household care, unsafe travel, early withdrawal from school and marriage before adulthood. These pathways interact: a girl who spends hours collecting water or caring for younger siblings may attend school nominally yet lose learning time; a family concerned about harassment may restrict her mobility rather than demand safer transport. Consequently, enrollment rates alone do not establish gender equality. Retention, learning, menstrual hygiene, safe commuting and adolescent decision-making matter.

The child-rights framework includes Articles 14, 15, 21 and 21A of the Constitution, the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012, and the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006. These laws address different risks; they cannot be replaced by a generic reference to 'women's empowerment'. District administrations must align schools, health services, child protection, police and local bodies. Adolescent girls should be consulted about transport, toilets, harassment and access to digital learning without making participation unsafe.

4.2 Child marriage is not automatically void in every case

The Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 generally treats child marriage as voidable at the option of the contracting party who was a child, subject to statutory conditions; specified circumstances can make marriages void. The distinction is examination-relevant. A child marriage prohibition officer may prevent an impending marriage, but legal assistance, shelter, protection from retaliation and continuity of education are required if the child refuses family pressure. A crude target such as 'number of marriages stopped' can incentivise concealment. Better indicators include re-enrolment, access to counselling and sustained safety after intervention.

A useful Telangana example is a seasonal-migration household that fears an adolescent girl will be left without supervision while adults travel for work. The risk is not solved by moral lectures. Safe hostels where appropriate, local schooling, reliable public transport, income support and trusted complaint routes reduce the pressure to arrange early marriage. Policy must address both social norms and material constraints.

5. Fluorosis in Nalgonda: environmental injustice and public-health governance

5.1 Understand the exposure pathway

Fluorosis results from prolonged excessive fluoride intake, frequently through drinking water. Groundwater fluoride varies with rock chemistry, residence time, pH and local hydrogeology; a district label does not prove that every borewell is unsafe. Dental fluorosis and skeletal fluorosis have different manifestations and severity. The correct analytical chain is source chemistry → exposure duration and quantity → health effects → household costs → service response. A government water-supply scheme is not evidence of exposure elimination unless the water actually consumed by households is tested and reliably delivered.

The Directorate General of Health Services identifies a desirable drinking-water fluoride level of 1.0 mg/L in the 2014 programme guidance; the widely used BIS permissible limit in the absence of an alternative source is 1.5 mg/L. These thresholds must not be confused. The National Programme for Prevention and Control of Fluorosis (NPPCF) supports surveillance, diagnostic capacity, community education, treatment and rehabilitation. Telangana's Nalgonda district administration reports establishing its District Fluoride Monitoring Centre on 14 November 2013 to coordinate prevention and response. Its historical risk figures should not be recycled as the current prevalence without new testing.

5.2 Why the burden is socially unequal

A low-income household may depend on a nearby borewell because piped supply is intermittent, purchased water is costly and carrying water consumes time. People with chronic skeletal disease may lose wages and

require travel for treatment, creating an additional poverty trap. Women and girls may bear disproportionate collection and caregiving burdens. This is why fluorosis belongs in social issues as well as geography: a naturally occurring chemical hazard becomes a distributive injustice when safe alternatives are unequal.

The 'Nalgonda technique' of chemical defluoridation is a historical engineering approach; it should not be described as a universally optimal household solution. Its effectiveness depends on correct dosing, sludge management, operation and monitoring. Sustainable solutions require source substitution where feasible, tested piped supply, transparent public water-quality data and clinical follow-up. In mains answers, distinguish source-level prevention from individual treatment: medical care cannot undo continued consumption of unsafe water.

5.3 Administrative case: apparently safe village

A village has a new tap-water network, but residents continue to use an old borewell during outages. A district officer should sample actual drinking points across seasons, disclose results in accessible language, ensure alternative safe supply, track downtime, and link suspected cases to health services. A report that 'all habitations are covered' is a service-infrastructure measure, not proof that all people receive safe water throughout the year. Equity requires identifying households without functional connections and people with disabilities who cannot collect water from distant standposts.

6. Child labour: schooling, household debt and supply chains

6.1 What law prohibits and what vulnerability looks like

The Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986, as amended, generally prohibits employment of children below 14 in occupations and processes, subject to limited statutory exceptions, and prohibits adolescents aged 14–18 from hazardous occupations and processes. The existence of exceptions is not a licence to employ children in dangerous or school-disrupting work. Constitutional Article 24, the Right to Education Act, juvenile-justice and child-protection frameworks operate alongside labour enforcement. The exact age, activity, hazard and effect on schooling must be established rather than inferred from appearance.

Telangana risk settings may include small workshops, construction subcontracting, informal retail, household work and seasonal agricultural operations. It is unsafe to assume a particular sector has a fixed prevalence without a current survey. Family debt and migration can increase risk, but employer demand for cheap and compliant labour is equally important. Some children appear in workplaces after school because care arrangements are unavailable; others are engaged in sustained economic production. Investigators must distinguish these situations while prioritising protection and education.

6.2 Why rescue and rehabilitation are different

An enforcement drive can remove children from a workplace yet leave the family without wages, documents or school access. Without follow-up, the child may return to another employer. Effective rehabilitation requires age-appropriate education or bridge learning, household livelihood assessment, counselling, coordination across source and destination districts, and inspection of the supply chain. For adolescents legally allowed to perform non-hazardous work under applicable law, safe conditions and schooling or skills pathways remain critical. Public dashboards should track re-entry to education and sustained attendance, not only raids.

A district magistrate confronting a subcontracted workshop must ask who controls wages, who recruited the children, whether identity documents are withheld and whether parents can be contacted safely. Employer responsibility should not disappear merely because the visible workshop is one tier below a larger purchaser. For mains, present this as an accountability chain: contractor → principal business → labour inspectorate → child welfare services → school.

7. Migrant labour: mobility is a right, exploitation is not

7.1 Migration patterns and layered vulnerability

Migration may be seasonal, circular or long-term, and can involve movement within Telangana, from Telangana to other states or into Hyderabad from elsewhere. Workers may move voluntarily for better earnings; migration itself must not be described as a social evil. The vulnerability arises when recruiters conceal terms, wages are

withheld, housing is unsafe, childcare is unavailable, or workers cannot access health care and ration benefits at destination. Linguistic difference, lack of documents and fear of dismissal make complaints difficult. Women migrants can face particular risks in domestic work and informal services.

The Inter-State Migrant Workmen (Regulation of Employment and Conditions of Service) Act, 1979 historically provided registration and contractor duties, including wage, journey and displacement protections under its specified conditions. Its relationship to the newer labour-code framework must be checked against the applicable commencement and transition notifications before making a current legal claim. Do not present an unverified code-commencement date as settled. For an administrative answer, name the legal framework but focus on verified worker protections: wage records, recruitment transparency, safe accommodation, accessible grievance systems and portability of entitlements.

7.2 Destination-city governance

Hyderabad's construction, logistics and service sectors can create demand for workers while imposing high housing and commuting costs. Municipal authorities may regard migrant settlements as temporary encroachments, whereas workers see them as the only affordable route to employment. A rights-based approach combines safe rental accommodation, sanitation, childcare, school admission, public-health outreach and transparent occupational safety inspection. The goal is not to prevent mobility but to make its risks manageable and benefits equitable.

Consider a group of workers whose children have missed three school terms because the family moves between brick kilns. A response limited to a one-time school admission fails. Source and destination education departments should coordinate portable records, bridge classes and continuity plans. Worker organisations and self-help groups can help communicate rights, but they cannot replace enforceable employer obligations. A high-quality answer distinguishes social protection portability, labour-law enforcement and urban planning as three separate but complementary policy tracks.

8. Telangana social movements: a comparative map rather than a single story

8.1 Agrarian and anti-Vetti mobilisation

The 1940s peasant struggle was rooted in land relations, coercive service, tenancy and the power of local landlords. Sanghams and political organisations offered collective bargaining and protection where individual resistance was dangerous. The movement's importance is not exhausted by military events: it shifted public discussion toward land, dignity and village power. However, claims about village counts, casualties or land redistribution must be tied to dated archival or scholarly sources; this supplement deliberately avoids unverified totals. Different groups experienced the movement differently, and later debates about violence and political strategy remain part of historical interpretation.

8.2 Women's anti-arrack organising and the politics of everyday life

The early-1990s anti-arrack movement in undivided Andhra Pradesh was prominently associated with rural women and literacy mobilisation in Nellore, while anti-liquor organising also had earlier and distinct strands in northern Telangana. These histories should not be collapsed into a claim that the entire movement began in Telangana. Women's protests made domestic violence, household spending and state excise revenue matters of public policy rather than 'private family problems'. Campaigns used petitions, village meetings, public demonstrations and pressure on licensing. A critical answer recognises both the agency of women and the limitations of prohibition when enforcement, illicit supply and livelihood transition are ignored.

The movement demonstrates a causal chain from literacy and discussion to collective organisation and policy change. Literacy was not simply the ability to read; it created meeting spaces where women compared experiences and named shared grievances. But not every participant held the same political position, and the political consequences of prohibition varied. For a mains answer, separate movement origins, forms of mobilisation, government response and unintended consequences.

8.3 Dalit dignity, caste discrimination and assertion

Dalit mobilisation in Telangana cannot be reduced to one organisation or election. It includes resistance to humiliating occupations, campaigns for access to land and education, legal action against atrocities, and demands for equitable distribution within reservation categories. Caste discrimination operates through social

exclusion, economic opportunity and public authority. A movement may therefore seek recognition, representation, redistribution or protection, sometimes simultaneously. Avoid treating Scheduled Castes as socially uniform: internal differences in occupational history, region and access to state benefits shape political claims.

The legal context includes constitutional equality guarantees, abolition of untouchability under Article 17, and the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989. Legal remedies matter, but a prosecution statistic alone does not establish social equality. A serious assessment considers whether victims can report without retaliation, whether schools and workplaces are inclusive, and whether public institutions act impartially. A social-movement answer should explain the distinction between a demand for legal enforcement and a demand to redesign resource distribution.

8.4 Adivasi land, forest and self-governance claims

Adivasi resistance in Telangana concerns alienation of land, forest access, recognition of customary livelihoods and control over local decisions. The slogan Jal, Jungle, Zamin expresses a claim to water, forests and land, but it is not itself a legal title document. In Scheduled Areas, the Fifth Schedule, relevant land-transfer protections, PESA and the Forest Rights Act, 2006 must be analysed in their respective jurisdictions. PESA's provisions concern Scheduled Areas; they cannot be assumed to apply identically to every Telangana village. Forest rights recognition and land-transfer enforcement require documentary and community processes, not merely symbolic recognition.

An administrator reviewing a disputed land transfer should establish whether the parcel is within a Scheduled Area, the applicable regulation, the parties' status, the transaction history and the relevant gram sabha process. Adivasi women and landless households should not be excluded from consultation by relying only on prominent male representatives. Social movements can improve visibility and oversight, but outcomes should be measured in recognised rights, restored possession and functioning local institutions.

8.5 Telangana statehood and cultural mobilisation

The Telangana statehood movement connected employment, irrigation, budget allocation and regional identity with student, employee, cultural and political mobilisation. Its historical phases must be distinguished: the 1969 agitation, later civil-society discussions and the mass mobilisation culminating in state formation in 2014 were not one uninterrupted campaign with identical leadership. Cultural performances, local-language expression and historical remembrance made complex distributional grievances accessible to broader audiences. The movement also included disagreement over strategy, party alliances and the future of Hyderabad; these should be acknowledged rather than erased.

Statehood is a constitutional-political outcome, not proof that all pre-existing social inequalities were solved. A balanced evaluation asks whether regional representation improved and whether women, Dalits, Adivasis, migrant workers and rural households experienced substantive gains. It is possible to recognise the legitimacy of regional identity while still evaluating post-formation public policy through measurable service delivery and social inclusion.

8.6 Women's self-help groups as collective institutions

Self-help groups and their village, mandal and district federations are not identical to protest movements, but they can build bargaining power, savings, credit access and collective voice. Telangana's Society for Elimination of Rural Poverty (SERP) describes community-based organisations organised from SHGs through village and higher federations. Such institutions may enable livelihood enterprise and social action, including responses to domestic violence or exclusion. However, loan disbursement does not automatically imply empowerment: debt stress, unequal decision-making and limited market access can undermine gains. A credible assessment examines who controls earnings, whether members can refuse loans and whether poorer women participate meaningfully.

9. Comparative analytical table

Problem or movement | Dominant mechanism | Core legal/institutional anchor | Common analytical error | Better outcome measure

Vetti | Caste, land and coercive service | Article 23; bonded labour legislation | Equating every low wage with Vetti | Durable exit, wages and rehabilitation

Jogini dedication | Gender-caste ritual coercion | Telangana Act 10 of 1988 | Assuming local name avoids prohibition | Survivor safety, schooling and autonomy

Child marriage | Gender norms and material insecurity | PCMA 2006; child protection | Saying all marriages automatically void | Prevention plus sustained protection

Fluorosis | Excess fluoride exposure | NPPCF; tested safe water | Equating piped connection with safe consumption | Verified safe water and clinical follow-up

Child labour | Employer demand and household vulnerability | Child/adolescent labour law; RTE | Counting rescues as rehabilitation | Sustained schooling and safe livelihood

Migrant labour | Recruiter dependence and weak portability | Migrant-work protections and welfare systems | Treating migration itself as exploitation | Portable rights and safe work

Women's anti-arrack action | Household harm and collective mobilisation | Excise policy; women's organisations | Treating regional origins as identical | Reduced harm with accountable enforcement

Adivasi land movements | Alienation and exclusion from decisions | Fifth Schedule; PESA; FRA | Treating slogans as legal titles | Secure rights and effective gram sabhas

10. Quick revision and exam-writing blueprint

Ten distinctions to retain: Vetti is not merely low pay; Jogini is expressly included in the statutory Devadasi definition; dedication is not legitimised by alleged consent; child marriage is generally voidable rather than automatically void; child labour and adolescent hazardous work have different legal tests; migrant mobility is not itself trafficking; groundwater coverage is not the same as safe consumption; the anti-arrack movement had geographically distinct strands; self-help groups are not always protest movements; state formation is not equivalent to eradication of social inequality.

For a 200–250-word mains answer, use six headed blocks: Context (25–30 words); Historical or structural causes (45); Mechanism and consequences (45); Law and institutional response (45); Critical limitations (35); Way forward/conclusion (25). Include a named Telangana case and one precise legal distinction. Avoid invented statistics and unsupported official-PYQ labels.

11. Dated evidence register and verification gaps (research-facing)

1. Constitution of India (1950), Articles 17, 23 and 24: primary constitutional framework; inspect current consolidated text before relying on amendments.

2. Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976: official India Code index, historical statutory foundation; current procedural notifications not audited.

3. Telangana Devadasis (Prohibition of Dedication) Act, 1988, adapted 28 April 2016: official India Code PDF directly indexed; precise statutory definitions and section 3 verified. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/8621/1/act_10_of_1988.pdf

4. Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986, as amended: India Code official index; detailed state inspection rules not retrieved. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/18544?view_type=browse

5. Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006 (enacted 2007): India Code official index; local court orders not retrieved. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/indiacode/handle/123456789/15426?view_type=browse

6. Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act, 1979: India Code official central-act index; verify labour-code commencement before asserting current applicability. https://www.indiacode.nic.in/handle/123456789/17114?view_type=browse

7. National Programme for Prevention and Control of Fluorosis, DGHS: government programme description updated 17 April 2025; reports 1.0 mg/L desirable fluoride threshold. https://dghs.mohfw.gov.in/nppcf.php

8. Nalgonda District Fluoride Monitoring Centre: official district account, established 14 November 2013; historical risk estimates are not current prevalence. https://nalgonda.telangana.gov.in/floride-monitoring/

9. Khammam DRDA–SERP institutional account: official Telangana district page; describes SHG and federation structure; live counts are administrative, not independent impact evaluation. https://khammam.telangana.gov.in/drda-serp/

10. Wanaparthy DRDA–SERP institutional account: official Telangana district page; describes collective action and women's SHG livelihood goals. https://wanaparthy.telangana.gov.in/district-rural-development-agency-drda/

11. Anti-arrack historical analysis, Anveshi: research commentary, not a signed government order; useful for contrasting Telangana and Nellore strands. https://www.anveshi.org.in/broadsheet-on-contemporary-politics/archives/broadsheet-on-contemporary-politics-vol-2-no-1011/anti-arrack-movement-prohibition-and-after-eenadus-strategic-support-and-silence/

12. Original archival gap: no authenticated village-level Vetti obligation registers, Jogini rehabilitation cohort, district-specific child-marriage prosecution dataset or complete 1990s anti-arrack organisational minutes obtained. Do not convert secondary narratives into primary-source certainty.

Academic gate: This supplement is original explanatory material, not an independent academic audit. Any numerical claims, historical dates, statute transition rules and community-specific generalisations require specialist review before approval.

30 original explained practice MCQs

Original practice questions; NOT authenticated TGPSC PYQs.

1. Which constitutional provision directly prohibits begar and comparable forced labour?

A. Article 23

B. Article 356

C. Article 30

D. Article 19(1)(a)

Answer: A. Article 23 prohibits forced labour; Article 24 separately addresses child employment in factories, mines and hazardous employment.

2. What is the central feature distinguishing Vetti from merely low-paid work?

A. Payment by the day

B. Agricultural setting

C. Absence of meaningful freedom to refuse imposed service

D. Seasonal timing

Answer: C. Vetti refers to coerced service embedded in local social power; not all low wages meet the same test.

3. Which Telangana historical episode prominently challenged forced agrarian service?

A. Quit India movement of 1942 alone

B. The 1956 linguistic reorganisation alone

C. The 2014 state election alone

D. Telangana peasant mobilisation of 1946–51

Answer: D. The peasant struggle challenged forced service, landlord levies and tenancy coercion, while later legal reforms are distinct events.

4. Which statute provides a specific legal framework for abolishing bonded labour?

A. Companies Act, 2013

B. Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976

C. Indian Forest Act, 1927

D. Official Languages Act, 1963

Answer: B. The 1976 Act addresses bonded labour obligations and associated debt, although the historical term Vetti is not an exact statutory synonym.

5. Why is rehabilitation needed after release from coercive labour?

A. Dependence and threats can reproduce coercion

B. Release cancels all poverty automatically

C. Workers must return to recruiters

D. Rehabilitation is only a police duty

Answer: A. Safe livelihoods, wages and housing are needed to make legal freedom sustainable.

6. Which regional practice is explicitly included in the 1988 Devadasis prohibition statute?

A. PESA

B. Panchayat Samiti

C. Jogini

D. Gram Sabha

Answer: C. The official Telangana-adapted text lists Jogini among labels covered by the definition.

7. What is the legal status of dedication under section 3 of the 1988 Act?

A. Unlawful and void even when consent is alleged

B. Valid with parental permission

C. Only prohibited in cities

D. Valid after adulthood

Answer: A. Section 3 rejects dedication regardless of purported consent and protects the woman’s legal status.

8. Which approach best protects a survivor of ritual dedication?

A. Confidential protection, legal action and sustained livelihood support

B. Punishment of the dedicated woman

C. A ceremony without follow-up

D. Public identification at a village meeting

Answer: A. Survivor autonomy and safety are the outcomes; public exposure can create further harm.

9. Why should Devadasi history not be treated as one uniform institution?

A. Only one region used the term

B. All participants had identical legal status

C. Historical roles varied by place and period

D. No historical performance tradition existed

Answer: C. A rigorous account distinguishes historical performance traditions from contemporary coercive dedication.

10. Which official document establishes the adaptation of the 1988 Act for Telangana?

A. The 1973 Six-Point Formula

B. The 2009 December statement

C. G.O.Ms.No.14 dated 28 April 2016

D. G.O.610 of 1985

Answer: C. The Telangana-adapted India Code text identifies the 2016 adaptation under the Reorganisation Act.

11. Which condition is most closely associated with prolonged excessive fluoride exposure?

A. Fluorosis

B. Malaria

C. Tuberculosis

D. Goitre from iodine deficiency

Answer: A. Fluorosis affects teeth and bones; laboratory water testing and exposure history are central.

12. Which Telangana district is a historically documented fluorosis case?

A. All districts uniformly

B. Nalgonda

C. Only Medchal

D. Only Hyderabad

Answer: B. Nalgonda district government documents groundwater fluoride and its monitoring centre; not every borewell is equally affected.

13. What was established in Nalgonda on 14 November 2013?

A. Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority

B. District Fluoride Monitoring Centre

C. National Green Tribunal

D. State Election Commission

Answer: B. The district government dates its coordination centre to 14 November 2013.

14. What does the DGHS NPPCF guidance identify as the desirable fluoride level?

A. 0.001 mg/L

B. 1.0 mg/L

C. 10 mg/L

D. 50 mg/L

Answer: B. DGHS describes 1.0 mg/L as desirable; distinguish it from the BIS permissible value under specified conditions.

15. What is the strongest evidence that a piped-water scheme reduces fluorosis exposure?

A. Repeated testing of water actually consumed

B. Budget allocation alone

C. Ribbon-cutting photographs

D. Number of pipes installed alone

Answer: A. Functional safe delivery, household use and clinical surveillance test real impact.

16. Which legislation addresses child marriage?

A. Right to Information Act, 2005

B. Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006

C. Representation of the People Act, 1951

D. Banking Regulation Act, 1949

Answer: B. The PCMA provides prevention and legal remedies; distinguish voidable from automatically void marriages.

17. Which statement about child marriage is legally more accurate?

A. Always automatically valid

B. Always automatically void without exception

C. Generally voidable, with specified cases void

D. Not regulated by Indian law

Answer: C. The PCMA differentiates voidability and particular void circumstances.

18. Which metric best tests girls' educational inclusion?

A. Sustained attendance, learning and safe access

B. Admission alone

C. Uniform distribution alone

D. School building count alone

Answer: A. Retention and meaningful access reveal burdens hidden by enrollment totals.

19. Which statute regulates child and adolescent labour?

A. Forest Conservation Act, 1980

B. Land Acquisition Act, 1894

C. Child and Adolescent Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986

D. Income-tax Act, 1961

Answer: C. The amended Act distinguishes children from adolescents and hazardous processes.

20. Which approach best prevents return to child labour after rescue?

A. Closing the case at first admission

B. Photographs of rescued children

C. A single raid

D. School reintegration with family livelihood support and follow-up

Answer: D. Rescue without educational and economic follow-through risks repeated exploitation.

21. What is a major risk in subcontracted labour supply chains?

A. Responsibility can be obscured across contractors

B. No worker can be recruited through agents

C. All subcontracting is illegal

D. All employers automatically keep complete records

Answer: A. Tracing recruitment, wage payment and the principal employer is necessary for accountability.

22. What is the correct analytical view of labour migration?

A. Mobility can be voluntary; exploitation arises from specific conditions

B. Every migrant is legally protected in practice

C. Every migrant is trafficked

D. Migration is a crime

Answer: A. Distinguish migration from coercive recruitment, wage theft and unsafe conditions.

23. Which historical Act specifically addresses inter-state recruited migrant workmen?

A. Municipalities Act alone

B. Indian Evidence Act, 1872

C. Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act, 1979

D. Official Secrets Act, 1923

Answer: C. The 1979 law specified contractor and employment duties; current transition to labour codes needs fresh verification.

24. What is an important migrant-child education measure?

A. Portable school records and bridge learning

B. Exclusion until permanent residence

C. No admission during seasonal moves

D. Only employer-run examinations

Answer: A. Continuity between source and destination schools reduces repeated learning disruption.

25. Which region is strongly associated with the early-1990s mass anti-arrack literacy mobilisation?

A. Nellore in undivided Andhra Pradesh

B. Only Adilabad forests

C. Only Hyderabad Old City

D. Only Warangal city

Answer: A. The mass anti-arrack movement was prominently rooted in Nellore; northern Telangana had distinct earlier anti-liquor organising.

26. Why did women’s anti-arrack campaigns become a public-policy issue?

A. They opposed literacy

B. They excluded local government

C. They linked household harm and state excise decisions

D. They concerned only a single family

Answer: C. Collective mobilisation connected domestic burdens to licensing and state revenue policy.

27. Which constitutional provision abolishes untouchability?

A. Article 17

B. Article 370

C. Article 280

D. Article 148

Answer: A. Article 17 is a direct equality guarantee; enforcement and social inclusion are separate tasks.

28. Which law provides protection against caste-based atrocities?

A. Companies Act, 1956

B. SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989

C. Patent Act, 1970

D. Motor Vehicles Act alone

Answer: B. The 1989 law addresses specified atrocities; accessible complaints and victim protection are critical.

29. Which legal regime is especially relevant to self-governance in Scheduled Areas?

A. PESA and Fifth Schedule protections

B. The Official Secrets Act alone

C. A blanket application to every village

D. The Companies Act alone

Answer: A. PESA applies to Scheduled Areas; scope and implementing rules must be checked.

30. What is the strongest test of a self-help group’s empowerment impact?

A. Number of meetings alone

B. Loan totals alone

C. Photographs of beneficiaries

D. Members’ agency, earnings control and inclusive decision-making

Answer: D. Credit disbursement may help, but substantive agency and reduced vulnerability are more meaningful outcomes.

Structured professional mains answer bank

Original practice questions — NOT verified TGPSC previous-year questions.

Revised from the preserved legacy answers with added original implementation tests. Not official PYQs.

Question: Vetti was more than an unpaid labour practice. Analyse.

Introduction

Vetti in historical Telangana signifies compelled or unpaid service embedded in unequal agrarian and caste relations. It was a system of domination because workers often lacked meaningful freedom to refuse.

Structural causes

Land dependence, credit obligations, hereditary service expectations and local power of landlords could reinforce one another. Loss of tenancy or housing was a threat that converted customary duty into coerced labour.

Social consequences

Vetti curtailed bargaining power, dignity and opportunities for schooling and alternative work. It also maintained the wider landlord structure by providing cheap services beyond ordinary agriculture.

Resistance and law

The 1946–51 Telangana agrarian struggle challenged forced labour alongside levies and evictions. Article 23 prohibits forced labour; the Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976 provides a related statutory protection, though the terms Vetti and bonded labour are not identical.

Critical insight

The examiner should distinguish involuntary service from ordinary low wages and show how caste rank, tenancy and credit generated a coercive bargaining environment. An anti-Vetti answer must specify what changed after agrarian resistance and what present-day accountability mechanisms prevent re-emergence.

Conclusion

Durable eradication requires livelihood independence, enforcement, safe complaints and rehabilitation. Ending a formal obligation without changing dependency may merely conceal coercion.

Implementation and outcome test

Implementation test: A field inquiry should separately document worker testimony, advance accounts, threatened eviction and access to independent wages. Release orders, housing and a safe complaint route matter more than raids alone.

Question: Explain the factors sustaining Jogini dedication and critically evaluate its prohibition.

Background

Jogini is a regional dedication practice involving girls or women. Its significance for contemporary policy lies in the intersection of ritual pressure, caste hierarchy, gender inequality and inadequate economic choice.

Root causes

Household poverty, limited schooling, vows linked to illness and unequal community norms can make refusal difficult. These are structural explanations, not cultural justifications.

Law

The Telangana Devadasis (Prohibition of Dedication) Act, 1988 treats dedication as unlawful and expressly includes Jogini within its statutory definition. Different local labels cannot create a lawful exemption.

Challenges

Survivors may experience stigma, health burdens and limited independent income after prohibition. Criminalisation without trusted counselling, privacy, education and livelihood rehabilitation risks pushing practices into invisibility.

Critical insight

The useful analytical contrast is between the ceremony's social label and the enforceable legal definition: the 1988 Telangana Act includes Jogini despite regional naming differences. Success must be measured through individual choice, school completion, rehabilitation and freedom from stigma.

Way forward and conclusion

Combine survivor-led prevention, legal enforcement, schooling, confidential healthcare and secure economic assets. The success indicator is actual freedom, not merely the number of ceremonies interrupted.

Implementation and outcome test

Implementation test: Monitor school attendance, confidential survivor follow-up and independent access to livelihood assets. Enforcement must target those who organise dedication, not the dedicated woman. Community education should avoid naming survivors publicly. The core outcome is sustained personal autonomy rather than the number of ceremonies stopped in an official campaign.

Question: Fluorosis in Telangana demonstrates the link between geography and social inequality. Discuss.

Introduction

Fluorosis arises from prolonged excessive fluoride exposure, typically through drinking water. The Nalgonda region illustrates how groundwater chemistry intersects with public health.

Geographic mechanism

Fluoride-bearing rocks, groundwater residence time and geochemical conditions may elevate dissolved fluoride. Contamination varies by source; borewell water cannot be assumed uniformly unsafe or safe.

Human consequences

Dental fluorosis affects enamel; skeletal fluorosis can damage bones and joints. Where households lack alternatives, chronic exposure may cause disability, schooling losses and reduced earning capacity.

Measures

A safe response combines periodic testing, alternative low-fluoride supply, properly operated defluoridation, school screening and clinical referral. Piped-water installation does not prove that safe water consistently reaches every home.

Critical insight

A policy answer must distinguish geological risk mapping from health surveillance. Safe drinking-water access is measured at the tap over time; treatment-plant construction totals cannot substitute for water-quality compliance, independent testing and follow-up of people already affected.

Conclusion

Fluorosis is preventable when geoscience, public-health follow-up and accountable local water service function together; otherwise natural groundwater risk becomes an inequitable social burden.

Implementation and outcome test

Implementation test: Compare laboratory results at the actual household drinking point with delivery reliability, not only source-level sampling. Track whether households return to unsafe borewells during supply outages and whether diagnosed patients receive rehabilitation. This distinguishes nominal infrastructure coverage from reduced exposure and improved capabilities.

Question: Child marriage persists despite legislation. Examine the Telangana policy response.

Introduction

Child marriage restricts agency, schooling and adolescent health. Its persistence is linked to gender inequality and uneven educational and economic opportunity.

Root causes

Household insecurity, dowry expectations, family-honour norms, safety concerns and weak secondary-school access can push families toward early marriage.

Law and safeguards

Under the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006, a child is a female below 18 or male below 21. Section 3 generally makes the marriage voidable at the option of the child party; specified other circumstances can make a marriage void. Child Marriage Prohibition Officers support prevention.

Policy gaps

Cancellation alone may expose a girl to retaliation or school dropout if safe accommodation, income and continuing education are missing. The elementary RTE framework covers ages 6–14, leaving a vital secondary-school retention challenge.

Critical insight

A distinctive implementation recommendation is to identify girls at risk of transition-related dropout before a wedding is arranged. Tracking secondary-school completion, safe travel, household support and repeat-risk cases better measures prevention than a simple count of cancelled marriages.

Conclusion

Focus on early detection, safe transport and residential schooling, confidential case support, parental engagement and long-term education outcomes rather than only prosecutions.

Implementation and outcome test

Implementation test: Protection officers should document the child’s wishes, immediate safety, continued schooling and any retaliation risk. Administrative targets based solely on prevented ceremonies can conceal coercion. Distinguish voidable and specified void marriages.

Question: Discuss why migrant labour requires portable social protection in Telangana.

Introduction

Hyderabad attracts workers while rural households may undertake seasonal and circular migration. Migrants contribute to growth but face service gaps when benefits remain tied to a fixed location.

Causes and patterns

Construction, services, manufacturing and brick kilns attract contractors and migrant workers. Intra-state migration differs from inter-state migration; not every movement is distress-driven.

Vulnerabilities

Informal housing, delayed pay, workplace injury, language barriers, lack of creches and interruptions to children’s schooling can undermine mobility gains.

Institutional measures

Ration portability is useful, but it cannot by itself assure health access, labour standards or school transfer. Wage records, safety inspections, bilingual grievance systems and affordable rental housing must travel with workers.

Critical insight

Migrant workers are not a homogeneous category. Age, gender, duration, occupation, home-state documentation and contractor arrangements alter vulnerability. Strong administration connects wage enforcement and social-security portability to schools, childcare and safe rental accommodation at actual worksites.

Conclusion

Public policy should protect the right to move safely and voluntarily, measuring wages received, injury risks, school continuity and benefits actually accessed.

Implementation and outcome test

Implementation test: A destination city should coordinate wage complaints, safe housing, ration portability, school admission and health outreach. Contracting chains must be mapped before responsibility is assigned. Worker mobility can improve income; policy should remove coercion and exclusion rather than treating all migration as trafficking.

Question: Explain the relationship between social movements and structural change in Telangana.

Introduction

Social movements convert persistent private grievances into collective claims for land, dignity, political voice and recognition.

Historical background

Andhra Mahasabha networks and village mobilisation addressed language and agrarian grievances. The 1946–51 Telangana peasant struggle challenged coercive land relations, levies and Vetti.

Different strands

Tribal struggles associated with Ramji Gond and Komaram Bheem occurred in distinct historical contexts. The 1969 agitation and subsequent regional mobilisation culminating in statehood in 2014 concerned safeguards, resources and self-government.

Critical assessment

Movements can secure legislation or political reorganisation without immediately eliminating caste exclusion, agrarian inequality or gender-based exploitation. Social mobilisation and public administration must therefore be evaluated separately.

Critical insight

Avoid claiming that political statehood automatically solved rural social inequality. An evidence-led assessment separates movement objectives, institutional concessions and longer-term outcomes for tenants, tribal communities, women and landless workers, using named organisations and distinct historical phases.

Conclusion

The lasting measure of social movement success is not mobilisation alone but enforceable access to land, welfare, schooling, safe work, dignity and democratic participation.

Implementation and outcome test

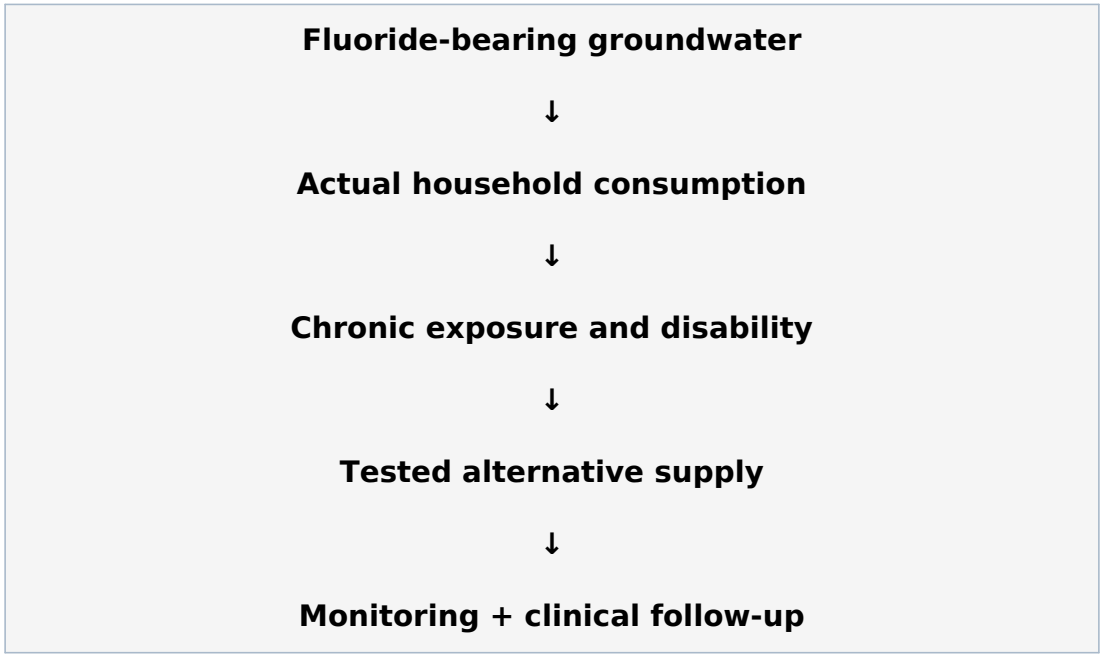
Implementation test: Compare movement demands with verifiable changes in land access, women’s safety, education and local decision-making. Recognise disagreements between organisations and distinguish symbolic gains from service outcomes. Telangana statehood and anti-arrack histories cannot be collapsed into one undifferentiated social-movement narrative.

Three original analytical diagrams

A. Coercive labour: why a release order is not sufficient



B. Fluorosis: exposure and policy pathway



C. Social movement to institutional outcome

Shared grievance and discussion

↓

Collective organisation

↓

Public claims and negotiation

↓

Legal or policy response

↓

Verified inclusion and service delivery